

Lab: Intro to Python 2

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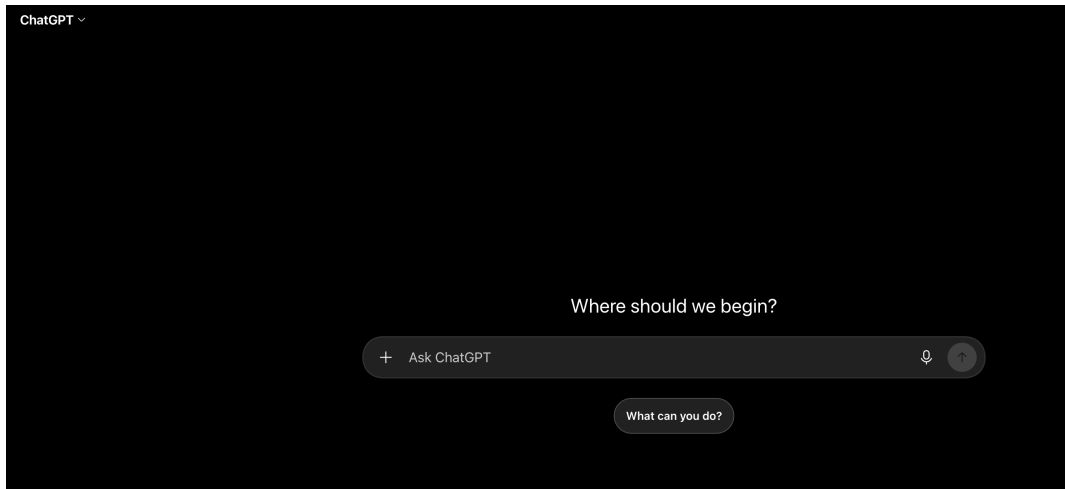
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Topics to cover

- Basic structure of a NLP tool
- (Review) Basics I
- Basics II, III

Basic structure of a NLP tool

NLP tools share a similar logic.



ChatGPT ▾

Where should we begin?

+ Tell me about yourself interview answer



Tell me about yourself interview answer

Tell me about yourself

Tell me about yourself worksheet

ChatGPT ▾

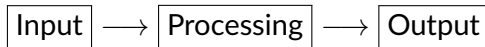
Tell me about yourself

Sure! I'm **GPT-5.6 Luna**, an AI assistant created by OpenAI.

A few things about me:

- 🧠 **I can reason and explain:** I can help with complex questions, break problems into steps, and explain things at whatever level you prefer.
- 📝 **I can write:** Emails, essays, stories, reports, captions, scripts, resumes, and more.
- 💻 **I can help with technical work:** Programming, debugging, system design, data analysis, and learning new technical concepts.
- 🌐 **I can research:** When you need current information, I can search the web and help compare sources.
- 💬 **I adapt to you:** You can ask for a quick answer, a detailed explanation, a beginner-friendly version, or something highly technical.
- 🎨 **I can work with creative ideas:** Brainstorming, visual concepts, storytelling, and image-related tasks.

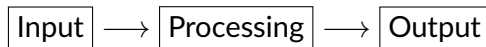
I don't have personal experiences, feelings, or a life outside our conversations—but I can still be a useful thinking partner.



- What do I give the tool? **a sentence**
- What do I want back? **some descriptions of the information**

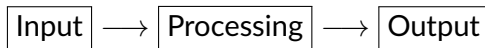
NLP tool starts with input and output

At the most basic level, an NLP tool does this:



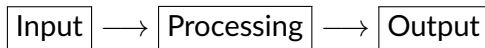
- **Input:** What do I give the tool?
- **Output:** What exactly do I want back?
- **Processing:** What needs to happen in between?





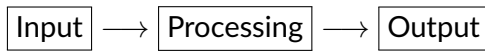
- **Input:** What do I give the tool? frozen rice
- **Output:** What exactly do I want back? eatable rice
- **Processing:** What needs to happen in between? $A(n)$ algorithm/mechanism/magic (?) that transforms the input into the output





- **Input:** What do I give the tool? stuffy hot air in my room
- **Output:** What exactly do I want back? nice cool air
- **Processing:** What needs to happen in between? $A(n)$ algorithm/mechanism/magic (?) that transforms the input into the output

Back to a text example



- **Input:** What do I give the tool? “I like corpus linguistics.”
- **Output:** What exactly do I want back? “I LIKE CORPUS LINGUISTICS.”
- **Processing:** What needs to happen in between?

What we learned in Python

"I like corpus linguistics." → "I LIKE CORPUS LINGUISTICS."

- **Values:** the actual pieces of data

```
"I like corpus linguistics."
```

- **Variables:** names that store values

```
text = "I like corpus linguistics."
```

- **Methods:** operations attached to an object

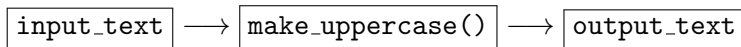
```
text.upper()
```

- **Functions:** reusable processing that takes input and returns output

```
make_uppercase(text)
```

Putting everything together

```
def make_uppercase(text):  
    return text.upper()  
  
input_text = "I like corpus linguistics."  
  
output_text = make_uppercase(input_text)  
  
print(output_text)
```



Basics I

Basics I.1. Values: Different kinds of data

```
text = "apple"  
number = 10  
decimal = 2.5  
is_ready = True  
empty = None
```

- **strings**
- integers
- floats
- booleans
- None

Basics I.1. Values: Type matters

```
"9" + "3"    # "93"
```

```
9 + 3        # 12
```

```
"9" + 3      # error
```

The type of a value determines what operations and methods are available.

Basics I.1. Values: Integers and floats

```
count = 7  
price = 3.5
```

```
count + 1      # 8  
price * 2      # 7.0
```

```
7 / 2          # 3.5  
7 // 2         # 3
```

Numeric types represent different kinds of numbers and support arithmetic operations.

Basics I.1. Values: Booleans

5 > 3 # ?

2 == 4 # ?

Basics I.5. Exercise 1

`Exercise1_Firstname_Lastname.py`

Complete the exercises from Basics I.

Your task

- Create one Python file
- Complete the assigned exercises
- Run your code and check the output
- Save the file using the required filename

Filename: `Exercise1_Firstname_Lastname.py`

Basics I.5. Exercise 1: Using VS Code Chat

- Several ways to use Chat:
 - ask what a piece of code means;
 - ask why you are getting an error;
 - ask how to modify your code;
 - **check whether your code does what you intended.**
- Try to use at least one chat session for each exercise.

Basics I.5. Exercise 1: Save your chat record

- After completing the exercise, export your VS Code Chat session.
- Save the exported chat record as:

`Exercise1_Firstname_Lastname_chat.json`

- Submit:
 - `Exercise1_Firstname_Lastname.py` (1 point)
 - `Exercise1_Firstname_Lastname_chat.json` (1 point)

Basics I.5. Exercise 1 (Example)

Class demo

Basics II, III

Basics II.1. Strings

```
s = "sample"
```

```
s[0]      # "s"
```

```
s[-1]     # "e"
```

```
s[0:2]    # "sa"
```

```
s[1:]     # "ample"
```

```
"sam" in s # True
```

A string is a **sequence of characters**.

- `[ ]`: access part of a string
- indexing starts at 0
- `[start:end]`: slicing
- `in`: check membership

Basics II.2. Lists

```
langs = ["Python", "R", "Java"]
```

```
langs[0]      # "Python"
```

```
langs[1:]     # ["R", "Java"]
```

```
langs.append("C++")
```

```
langs[0] = "Julia"
```

A list is an **ordered collection of values**.

- items can be accessed by index
- lists can contain multiple values
- lists are **mutable**
- `.append()` adds an item
- `.remove()` removes an item

Basics II.3. Conditional Statements

```
x = 2

if x < 2:
    print("less")

elif x == 2:
    print("equal")

else:
    print("greater")
```

Conditionals let the program make a **decision**.

- if: check a condition
- elif: check another condition
- else: otherwise

Basics II.4. Loops

```
words = ["read", "code", "repeat"]
```

```
for w in words:  
    print(w)
```

```
count = 0
```

```
while count < 3:  
    print(count)  
    count += 1
```

Loops let us **repeat an operation**.

- for: repeat for each item
- while: repeat while a condition is true

Basics III.1. Tuples

```
t = (1, 2, 3, 4)
```

```
t[0]      # 1
```

```
t[-1]     # 4
```

```
t[1:3]    # (2, 3)
```

```
x, y, *rest = t
```

A tuple is similar to a list, but it is **immutable**.

- ordered sequence
- supports indexing and slicing
- **cannot be changed in place**
- useful for fixed groups of values

Basics III.2. Dictionaries

```
freq = {  
    "the": 69033,  
    "of": 36998,  
    "and": 30157  
}  
  
freq["the"]          # 69033  
freq["to"] = 21892  
  
freq.keys()  
freq.values()  
freq.items()
```

A dictionary stores **key-value pairs**.

- each key identifies a value
- access values using a key
- keys must be unique
- very common for storing linguistic information

Basics III.3. Functions

```
def greet(name):  
    return "Hello, " + name
```

```
message = greet("Alice")
```

```
def divide(a, b):  
    return a / b
```

Functions package **reusable processing**.

- parameters receive input
- code inside performs processing
- return sends output back

Basics III.4. Classes (advanced)

```
class Text:
    def __init__(self, content):
        self.content = content

    def make_lowercase(self):
        return self.content.lower()

text = Text("HELLO")
text.make_lowercase()
```

A class groups **data and behavior** together.

- class: blueprint
- object: an instance of the class
- attributes: data
- methods: operations

Basics III.5. Working with Files

```
# Write
with open("fruits.txt", "w") as f:
    f.write("apple\n")

# Read
with open("fruits.txt", "r") as f:
    text = f.read()
```

Programs often need to read or save data.

- "r": read
- "w": write
- open(): open a file
- with: close it automatically

Different Ways to Store Data

- .txt — plain text
- .csv — rows and columns
- .json — structured key-value data

Basics II, III. Exercises

Exercise2_Firstname_Lastname.py (1 point)

Exercise2_Firstname_Lastname_chat.json (1 point)

Exercise3_Firstname_Lastname.py (1 point)

Exercise3_Firstname_Lastname_chat.json (1 point)

Your task

- Create one Python file
- Complete the assigned exercises
- Run your code and check the output
- Save the file using the required filename

Exercise 4: Find the Longest Word in Each Line

Suppose you are given a text file called `sentences.txt`.

Example file:

```
I like corpus linguistics
Python is useful for text analysis
Natural language processing is fascinating
```

For each line, find and print the **longest word**.

Desired output:

```
linguistics
analysis
fascinating
```

► [hint!](#)

Preview: Assignment 1 (Deadline: 9/11)

Each exercise is worth **2 points**. Total: **10 points**.

- **Exercise 1:** Submit your .py and .json
- **Exercise 2:** Submit your .py and .json
- **Exercise 3:** Submit your .py and .json
- **Exercise 4:** Submit your .py and .json
- **Exercise 5:** Complete *A Survey of Corpora* (next week)

Appendix

Decompose the problem

Think about what needs to happen for **each line**:

1. Split the line into words.
2. Start with one word as the current longest word.
3. Look at each word one at a time.
4. Compare its length with the current longest word.
5. If it is longer, replace the current longest word.
6. Print the final result.

